

Ayaka Murata Naganuma

CLIMATE ADAPTATION · DISASTER RECOVERY · EQUITABLE URBAN PLANNING

✉ ayaka-qc.github.io

✉ anagao26@uottawa.ca

☎ +81 80-3497-9545

in ayaka-naganuma

📍 University of Ottawa, 120 University Private, Ottawa, Ontario, K1N 6N5

Education

- 09/26 - 08/31 (Expected) **University of Washington** Seattle, United States
Interdisciplinary PhD in Urban Design and Planning
Supervisors: **Daniel Abramson, Rachel Berney, Jan Whittington**
- 09/24 - 08/26 (Expected) **University of Ottawa** Ottawa, Canada
Master of Arts in Public and International Affairs
Supervisor: **Nicholas Rivers**.
Relevant Courses: Quantitative Research Methods (A+), Public Finance (A), Ethics and Moral Reasoning (A-), Economics of the Environment (A), Public Policies: Design and Instruments (A).
- 04/13 - 03/17 **Yokohama City University** Yokohama, Japan
Bachelor of Arts and Science in Global, Regional, and Urban Studies
Dissertation: "Overseas Expansion of small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) in Ota-ku, Tokyo: Foreign Direct Investment in Thailand and the Clustering of SMEs" (Evaluation: Excellent, A+).
Supervisor: **Eiichi Yoshida**.

Research Experience

- 10/24 - present **Global Infrastructure Fund Research Foundation Japan** Tokyo, Japan (Remote)
Visiting Fellow
Supervisors: **Dr. Mikiyasu Nakayama, Dr. Naori Miyazawa, and Ms. Akiko Sakamoto**.
Topic: Climate adaptation strategies and environmental migration in small island developing states.
Designs surveys; conducts statistical (e.g., significance testing, correlation, factor analysis, SEM) and causal analyses; and co-authoring research papers.
- 01/25 - 04/25 **Broadbent Institute** Ottawa, Canada
Graduate Policy Researcher
Supervisor: **Mr. Clement Nocos**, Director of Policy and Engagement.
Topic: Labor Mobility and Just Transition in Canada's High-Emission Sectors.
Applied quantitative (e.g., correlation, PCA) and qualitative analysis to develop policy recommendations.
Produced a final research report and presented findings at the Progress Summit 2025.
- 08/24 - 09/24 **University of Ottawa (Telfer School of Management)** Ottawa, Canada
Research Assistant
Supervisor: **Prof. Nelson Dueñas**.
Topic: Locally led international development: accounting and management in the Global South.
Conducted qualitative research on accountability in humanitarian support. Reviewed 50+ studies, developed a structured literature review, and created a research briefing to clarify practices for stakeholders.
- 04/23 - 08/24 **Concordia University (Institute for Cultural-Clinical Psychology)** Montreal, Canada
Research Assistant
Supervisor: **Prof. Andrew G. Ryder**.
Topic: Acculturation, mental health, and social support among Japanese immigrants in Canada.
Conducted statistical modelling (XGBoost, decision trees) to analyze mental-health determinants; designed data-collection strategy that increased sample size fivefold.
- 04/22 - 03/24 **Gakushuin University (Research Institute of Economics and Management)** Tokyo, Japan (Remote)
Research Assistant
Supervisor: **Prof. Takaho Ueda**.
Topic: Sustainable regional development and brand strategies.
Conducted literature reviews on the Territorial Approach in Italy and developing countries. Designed and executed case study research on bottom-up approaches for sustainable development and presented findings at academic conferences.

Professional Experience

- | | |
|---------------|---|
| 10/25 - 03/26 | United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
Bonn, Germany (Remote)
Intern for the Adaptation Division, Vulnerability sub-division
Conducts research on climate impacts, vulnerability, and adaptation, including contributions to the Integrated Knowledge System (IKS). Supports the Lima Adaptation Knowledge Initiative (LAKI) and University Partnership through workshop coordination and stakeholder engagement. Assists COP30 preparations under the Nairobi Work Programme. |
| 01/23 - 03/23 | United Nations Information Center Tokyo
Tokyo, Japan (Hybrid)
Strategic Communications Intern
Led a successful International Women's Day social media campaign. Conducted quantitative surveys for UNIC-led climate action initiatives. Enhanced global media monitoring efficiency and managed social media content to raise public awareness of global issues. |
| 04/19 - 12/21 | Relo Vacations, Ltd.
Tokyo, Japan
Director of Brand Strategy / Sales Planning Team Manager / Revenue Manager
Improved performance of multiple hotels through revenue management, marketing, and forecasting, leading to higher occupancy and profitability. |
| 04/17 - 03/19 | Kanagawa Prefectural Government
Yokohama, Japan
Public Servant, Private School Affairs Division
Conducted audits for 300+ private and language schools and supported improvements in management and educational infrastructure. |

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. **Naganuma, A.**, Uakeia, T., and Seru, J. "Heterogeneity in Climate Risk Perception and Rights-Based Protection: A Multi-Group Analysis in the Marshall Islands and Kiribati." *Journal of Disaster Research*, 21(4), August 2026. In press.
2. Sakamoto, A., Laila, A., **Naganuma, A.**, Nishimura, T., and Rasheed, S. "Assessing the Association of Urban and Economic Foundations with Post-Migration Life Satisfaction in the Maldives: Evidence from Voluntary Migrants to Hulhumalé, Maldives." *Journal of Disaster Research*, 21(4), August 2026. In press.
3. Sakamoto, A., Kunitake, Y., Laila, A., **Naganuma, A.**, and Rasheed, S. "The Agent of Change: How the Migration Decision-Maker Shapes Elderly Life Satisfaction in Hulhumalé, Maldives." *Journal of Disaster Research*, 21(4), August 2026. In press.

Reports and Other Publications

1. **Ayaka Naganuma**. "Bridging the Transition: Labour Mobility and Workforce Adaptation in Canada's Just Transition." *Broadbent Institute Report*, April 2025.
2. **Ayaka Naganuma**. "The Loneliness Faced by Japanese Immigrants and the Importance of Mother Tongue Education and Community: Based on Articles from the North American Post in the 1950s." *JICA Academic Essay Contest Publication*, October 2024. **(Excellence Award)**

Selected Working Papers

1. **Naganuma, A.** "Inclusion by Design: Procurement Architecture and Local Participation in ADB Climate Infrastructure." Policy brief under review, Asian Development Bank Sustainable Procurement Resource Hub, 2026.
2. **Naganuma, A.** "Causal Effects of Workplace Safety Regulation on Employment and Wages: Evidence from California's Heat Illness Prevention Standard."
3. **Naganuma, A.** "Impact of the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism and Canada's Carbon Pricing: A Partial-Equilibrium Approach to Canada's Steel Sector." Preprint; SSRN PDF.

Selected Presentations

1. “Loneliness and Mother-Tongue Education among Japanese Immigrants.” **JICA Yokohama Overseas Migration Museum Online Seminar**, Excellence Award Lecture. (Online, 12/25)
2. “Bridging the Transition: Labour Mobility and Workforce Adaptation in Canada’s Just Transition.” **Broadbent Institute Progress Summit 2025**, Workshop on Green Industrial Policy. (Ottawa, Canada, 04/25)
3. “Review of Research on Social Support Needs and Sources.” **Joint Research Presentation, Concordia University and ISCTE-IUL**. (09/23)
4. “Italy’s Territorial Approach and the Commercialization of Rural Area: A Case Study of Mount Amiata in Italy.” **Gakusyuin University Institute of Economic Research**. (06/23)

Other Research Presentations

- “Assessing Environmental Inequality in Air Pollution Exposure: Preliminary Spatial Analysis for Montreal.” University of Ottawa, Quantitative Research Methods final presentation. (11/25) *Presentation Available Here. Report Available Here.*

Selected Honors, Grants, and Fellowships

09/26 - 08/29	Japanese Government Fellowship - PhD program	JAPAN STUDENT SERVICES ORGANIZATION
09/25 - 08/26	Japanese Government Fellowship - Master’s program	JAPAN STUDENT SERVICES ORGANIZATION
2025	GSPIA Imagination Scholarship 2025 ¹	UNIVERSITY OF OTTAWA, GSPIA ²
09/24 - 12/25	Scholarship for International Students (CUPE Local 2626)	UNIVERSITY OF OTTAWA
2024	Excellence Award, Academic Essay Contest on Japanese Emigration	JICA ³

Professional Activities & Volunteering

10/24 - 11/24	UN ESCAP (via UNV Online) Data Analyst Analyzed Voluntary National Review (2016–2024) data to identify key trends and patterns.	Remote
09/24 - 10/24	Southern Africa Embrace Foundation (via UNV Online) Fundraising Coordinator Developed a concept note and fundraising strategy for the foundation’s education program.	Remote
03/24 - 06/24	UPG Sustainability Leader 2024 Sustainability Leader (Class of 2024 with Distinction) Selected from over 13,000 applicants for a global UN SDG leadership program; first Japanese participant.	Remote
02/24	OECD Youth Consultation - Asia-Pacific Asia-Pacific Youth Representative Provided youth input to OECD policy discussions on social inclusion.	Remote

Skills & Certifications

Languages: Japanese (Native), English (Professional Proficiency), French (Basic)

Technical Skills: Causal Inference (DiD, Event Study); Applied Quantitative Analysis (Statistics, Econometrics, ML); Spatial and Environmental Data Analysis; Qualitative Research; Policy Analysis; Project Management

Programming & Software: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch), R, Stata, Sas, SQL, ETEX, NVivo

¹Graduate School of Public and International Affairs

²Awarded to one student in the English-language cohort of the GSPIA Master’s program. See: 2025 GSPIA Imagination Scholarship Recipients.

³Japan International Cooperation Agency